

We are now in the **ז' דנהמתא**, the seven weeks of comfort following **תשעה באב**, which continue all the way until **ראש השנה**. The first **פסוקים** of each of the haftorahs of the **ז' דנהמתא** are a dialogue between **הקדוש ברוך** and **כלל ישראל**. The first is when **כלל ישראל** cries to Hashem. **וְתֹאמַר צִיּוֹן עֲזָבָנִי: (ישעיהו מ"ט:י"ד)** in **ציון** cries bitterly **ה' יְהוָה שָׁכַחְנִי**. This is a bitter cry. It is not an accusation; it is a cry, a weeping: Hashem, You have forgotten us.

Towards the end of the **הפטרה**, there's a **פסוק** which profoundly answers that cry. It's the next to the last **פסוק** of the **הפטרה**: **הִבֵּיתוּ אֶל אֲבֹתֵיכֶם וְאֶל שָׂרָה תְּחִלָּתְכֶם כִּי אָהָד קָרָאתִיו וְאַבְרָהָם וְאַרְבֶּהוּ וְאַרְבֶּהוּ: (ישעיהו מ"ט:י"ד)** - Look to Avraham your father, and to Sarah; **תְּחִלָּתְכֶם** - who started you off, the foundation; **כִּי אָהָד קָרָאתִיו** - I called them once; **וְאַבְרָהָם וְאַרְבֶּהוּ** - and I benched them and I made them multiply.

The **sefer חלל תורה**, from the **מענה של תורה**, brings in the name of Rav Aharon ben Chaim from Izmir, the **מדרש**. He explains that any place in **תנ"ך** where it uses the expression **אין לה**, it means **אין לה** now, but in the future she will have. He gives three examples:

- 1) **וְתִהְיֶה שָׂרִי עֲקָרָה אֵין לָהּ וָלֶד (בראשית י"א:ל')** - She had no children, but later Hashem answered her.
- 2) **וְכָא לְצִיּוֹן גּוֹאֵל (ישעיהו נ"ט:כ')** and then it says **צִיּוֹן הָיָא דִּרְשָׁא אֵין לָהּ (ירמיהו ל"ז:י"ז)**.
- 3) **וְכָא לְצִיּוֹן גּוֹאֵל (ישעיהו נ"ט:כ')** and then it says **אֵין לָהּ מְנַחֵם (איכה א':ב')**.

So any place in **תנ"ך** where we have the phrase **אין לה**, you should know it means **אין לה** now, but not forever. That's what the **פסוק** is saying: **הִבֵּיתוּ אֶל אֲבֹתֵיכֶם וְאֶל שָׂרָה תְּחִלָּתְכֶם** - You are crying now, so think about this: look back to the first of the **אבות**, Avraham, and to Sarah. They were elderly, naturally unable to have children - ninety years old, long past the point of hope. It was a bitter situation.

How are we in **גלות**? In an even more bitter situation. We might think there is nothing coming to us - **אין לה** and **מְנַחֵם אֵין לָהּ** - we are never going to get out of this. But no, says the Navi: **אין לה** and **מְנַחֵם אֵין לָהּ** are only for now.

And what does the **פסוק** say? **כִּי אָהָד קָרָאתִיו** - I called them; **וְאַבְרָהָם וְאַרְבֶּהוּ** - just as I blessed them and they multiplied, and **כלל ישראל** came forth from these two individuals, so too here. Even though it says **אין לה** now, do not give up hope. Even in the darkest days, never give up hope. **כִּי נָחַם הַשֵּׁם צִיּוֹן** - in the end, Hashem will comfort **ציון**. It is only **אין לה** now, but in the end, there will be **מְנַחֵם**.

The day that I'm taping this happens to be the day that the Iranian government **שמע** came out with an announcement that they're going to attack Israel on **תשעה באב** because that's the day of their misfortunes. I immediately fired back to anyone who got my text message, those guys just like Haman, who didn't know that **ז' אדר** was not only a day when **משה רבינו** died, but **ז' אדר** is the day **משה רבינו** was born. So too, in our time, **תשעה באב** is going to become the biggest **יום טוב**. When you hear this podcast, this talk, it will already be after **תשעה באב**, and I'm hoping by then we will see a great **ישועה**, and Hashem will answer us and we will see the great **נחמה**, and **הלוואי משיח** should come already.

